Introduction

According to the PERIOD poll, 73% of respondents have felt pressure to tough out their period pain and 74% of the respondents heavily downplayed how much pain they were feeling during their period. Current issues of menstrual education lie in building confidence, care and participation - not just for hygiene regulation.

Large repositories of content have so many kinds of resources ranging from so many different topics, that it could cause anxiety and mistrust in women. Pain management education and remedy activities should be encouraged and shared with women, because pain is something that should never be ignored during your periods.

The problem space involves understanding the ways a period management tool could help women manage their pain without suppressing or ignoring the pain. In the discovery phase, I conducted a competitive analysis where I found the most common applications that women use to educate themselves about menstrual health. My criteria for comparison involved comparing the content of the applications.

Comparative Space

App	Main educational-content inputs	Review / governance disclosed publicly	Important qualification
Flo	Current research, clinical guidelines, collaboration with doctors and health experts, and partnerships with health organizations.	Flo says it works with 140+ doctors and health experts; content is reviewed by two field experts. It cites links to UNFPA, EBCOG, GLOWM, and ACOG relationships.	The app also has community-oriented content; that is different from clinically reviewed education.
Clue	Scientific studies, publications, and guidance from public-health and professional bodies, notably CDC, WHO, and ACOG.	Actionable health articles are fact-checked; articles include reference lists and are revised as medical knowledge changes. Its content team includes scientists, clinicians, journalists, and editors.	Clue explicitly says user-community posts are not moderated for medical accuracy.

Eve by Glow	App-generated cycle/fertility information, published articles/marketing content, and user community discussion	Glow presents its products as AI-driven and says its information does not replace professional medical advice, but I could not find a comparably detailed public editorial policy identifying systematic use of guidelines, citations, or named medical review.	Treat the community as peer support, not a source of vetted medical education.
WHOOP for women	User-specific physiological data—such as HRV, resting heart rate, skin temperature, sleep, and training load—combined with expert commentary, research, and advisory-board input	WHOOP's Scientific Advisory Council includes an OB-GYN, women's-health physician/nutritionist, and female-performance scientist; it says advisors can contribute coaching content and influence product development.	Its menstrual-cycle phases are estimates; WHOOP says the feature is not medical advice and should not be used for conception or contraception.

Flo

Flo characterizes its library as evidence-based reproductive and sexual-health education. Its public clinician-facing materials say more than 140 doctors and health experts collaborate on content, with each piece reviewed by two relevant experts; it also points to research and clinical guidelines as foundations for the content. Flo says it has more than 5,000 educational resources across articles, videos, and courses.[med.flo][med.flo]

The named external ecosystem Flo highlights includes the United Nations Population Fund, the European Board & College of Obstetrics and Gynaecology, the Global Library of Women's Medicine, and ACOG. These affiliations and collaborations signal a clinically oriented sourcing strategy, although a sponsorship or partnership is not the same thing as independent approval of every individual item.[med.flo]

Clue

Clue is the most transparent of the four about its editorial sourcing. It says its writers and fact-checkers use scientific studies and publications from health authorities including the CDC, WHO, and ACOG. It further states that health articles have reference lists, are dated, and are periodically revised.[helloclue]

For new or uncertain topics, Clue says it looks first for the highest-quality, current research, scientific consensus, and clinical "gold standards," then considers emerging research while labeling findings that are preliminary, controversial, or insufficiently replicated. Its content is written by reproductive-health clinicians and science writers, and the company also conducts

research and collaborates with research partners under scientific, ethical, and data-protection standards.[helloclue][helloclue][helloclue]

Eve by Glow
Eve is Glow's period-tracking app, positioned as part of a broader women's-health and fertility app portfolio. Glow describes its services as AI-driven and offers period/cycle tracking, fertility features, and community functionality; it also states that information in its fertility product should not replace medical advice from a healthcare professional.[glowing][glowing]
However, based on Glow's readily accessible public materials, there is less source transparency than at Flo or Clue. A Glow web article does cite a study from Obstetrics & Gynecology Science, showing that it may draw on peer-reviewed literature, but one cited marketing article does not establish a comprehensive editorial standard.[wp.glowing]

Glow also hosts discussion forums, including questions where users exchange recommendations for outside PCOS or fertility-awareness resources..[glowing][glowing]

WHOOP for women
WHOOP's educational model is different because it is primarily a performance wearable, not a conventional period-content library. Its menstrual-cycle insights draw on measured physiological signals (particularly resting heart rate, heart-rate variability, skin temperature, sleep, and strain) and show how those metrics change across estimated cycle phases. WHOOP says it does not directly measure hormones.[whoop]
For education and product development, WHOOP relies on a Scientific Advisory Council of physicians, scientists, and health-tech experts. Members include OB-GYN Dr. Jessica Shepherd, exercise physiologist and nutrition scientist Dr. Stacy Sims, and physician/nutritionist Dr. Hazel Wallace; WHOOP says the council helps ground its experience in science and can contribute to in-app digital coaching. WHOOP also reports supporting reproductive-health research and has highlighted a collaboration with Clue.[whoop][whoop][whoop][whoop]
The key limitation is explicit: WHOOP says menstrual-cycle insights are not a medical device or medical advice, and cycle-phase estimates—including ovulation—should not be used for conception or contraception.[whoop]

Research Objectives

1. To develop a solution that helps women manage period pain, based on techniques and tricks that work for them.
2. To explore how participants react to the concept's tone, including whether it makes them feel comfortable and confident to act on their pain or dismissed, worried, or talked down to.
3. To explore how the activities and/or information fits what participants already do when pain starts.

Next Steps

The next steps for this project is to pass out a survey, to collect measurable data about the kinds of the kinds of informational content and resources women look out to get help during period pain, as well as conduct interviews. I have defined different objectives to help gather data and generate valuable insights from the same.

This week, I will be conducting a pilot launch of my survey, to see if I am getting the information I need for the project. Then I will be working on officially sharing the survey in different all-women channels in Instagram and Slack. If the women consent to the interviews, I will schedule time to interview them. I will want to complete this by the end of October to give me more time to be able to analyse the data and create the prototypes for the project.

Survey Research Objectives

1. To have a measure of the current strategies women are following to relieve or manage period pain, as well as what is stopping them from getting the information they need.
2. To measure what activities or information women actually look for when they are trying to relieve pain and measure the current gaps in current tools and communities.
3. To measure the impact of pain in allowing women to live their lives the way they want to

Interview Research Objectives

1. To understand how women move from noticing a menstrual symptom or question to forming an understanding of it.
2. To understand the reasoning participants use to decide which sources to believe and act on, and the role each source (apps, social media, search, AI, peers, clinicians) plays.
3. To understand what makes someone decide a symptom is or isn't worth professional care, and which informational, emotional, financial, or logistical barriers shape that decision.